

11 Inbuilt applications

One of the reasons of iPhone's tremendous success is the number of built-in applications that come with it. These applications which include Contacts, Mail, SMS, Safari, Phone, and Calendar perform most of the tasks required by an average user. These applications can be programmatically invoked from within your application through the various API's provided in the iPhone SDK so that you can work synchronously with them and interact with them from within your application.

11.1 Accessing the photo library

The iPhone SDK allows you to programmatically invoke the Photos application and displays a UI which lets the user select pictures or videos from their albums and then you can use them in our application. This is made possible with the UIImagePickerController class of the SDK. To demonstrate this, let us create a new View-based Application in Xcode. We will name it PhotoLibraryAccess. Open the PhotoLibraryAccessViewController.xib in the Interface Builder by double-clicking on the file. Next, populate your View window with a Button View and an UIImageView. Label the button as "Load a photo from the Library". Also, set the mode in the Attributes Inspector window of the UIImageView to Aspect fit.

Now open the PhotoLibraryAccessViewController.h file and add the following source code in it:

```
##import <UIKit/UIKit.h>

@interface PhotoLibraryAccessViewController :
    UIViewController
<UINavigationControllerDelegate,
    UIImagePickerControllerDelegate> {
    IBOutlet UIImageView *imageView;
    UIImagePickerController *imagePicker;
}
@property (nonatomic, retain) UIImageView *imageView;
-(IBAction) btnClicked: (id) sender;
@end
```

Go back to the Interface Builder window and drag the File Owner's item to the UIImageView view by control clicking and dragging. Also select the UIImageView. After this, control click on the Button view and drag it to the